nature of freedom, its extent and limits than all the philosophical discourses on this theme." Douglass's movement across boundaries—both geopolitical and psychological—draws her close attention. Davis writes: "*The Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass* constitutes a physical voyage from slavery to freedom that is both the conclusion and reflection of a philosophical voyage from slavery to freedom. We will see that neither voyage would have been possible alone; they are mutually determinant." She reinforces the idea that the act of writing becomes a way of problematizing and locating spaces of repression and freedom.[43]

In her first major interview following her flight from California and later arrest (an interview that would later be included in *Angela Davis Speaks*), Davis shares her first public statements about her imprisonment. The conversation was carried out by childhood friend and member of her legal team Margaret Burnham (based on questions from respondents in Harlem, published in *Muhammed Speaks*).[44] They cover issues that mainly focus on questions surrounding her court case, as well as her feelings about communism and her rationale for her flight from authorities in California. She describes the conditions inside the Women's House of Detention as horrid and inhumane: "This is a prison and the atrocious conditions that characterize virtually every American prison are present in this place. … First of all, this prison is filthy. It's infested with roaches and mice. … A few days ago, I was drinking a cup of coffee and was forced to spit out a roach. They literally cover the walls of our cells at night, crawling across our bodies as we sleep."[45] Here, Davis shares a literal description of the walls of a decrepit prison that interface and impact the bodies of the inmates, a condition of gross treatment and neglect. She constructs a shared image of the unjust conditions of detention for those on both sides of prison walls, by describing the structural and personal conditions of incarceration.[46]

During her imprisonment Davis's defense strategy was to place her individual case of incarceration in a greater context of political prisoners, all the while drawing on specifics of her own life. Her defense committee's *Political Biography of Angela Davis* drew out her life development as an intellectual and a freedom fighter. The cover features Davis in front of a poster of scholar and activist W. E. B. Du Bois, and the pamphlet opens with a preamble that cites Davis's own words: "The struggle of a true revolutionary is 'to merge the personal with the political where they're no longer separate.'" Members of her defense committee cite her words and